

IAS PRELIMS/MAINS

Ecology & Environment

A stylized illustration of a green city skyline with various skyscrapers, wind turbines, and a sun, set against a light green background with a globe-like shape.

A COMPREHENSIVE COVERAGE

MODULE - 50

International Environmental Conventions - 3

THE UNITED NATIONS CONVENTION TO COMBAT DESERTIFICATION (UNCCD)

- The COP is the supreme decision-making body.
- To date, the COP had held fourteen sessions; it has been meeting biennially since 2001.
- COP14 took place in 2019 in New Delhi.
- The Conference adopted the Delhi Declaration in which parties expressed commitment for a range of issues, including gender and health, ecosystem restoration, taking action on climate change etc.
- The Committee on Science and Technology (CST) is established as a subsidiary body of the Conference of the Parties (COP) to provide it with information and advice on scientific and technological matters.



GLOBAL MECHANISM

The Global Mechanism (GM) was established under the UNCCD to assist countries in the mobilization of financial resources to implement the Convention and address desertification, land degradation and drought.



United Nations
Convention to Combat
Desertification



THE GLOBAL
MECHANISM

UNITED NATIONS CONVENTION
TO COMBAT DESERTIFICATION

THE UNITED NATIONS CONVENTION TO COMBAT DESERTIFICATION (UNCCD)

LAND DEGRADATION NEUTRALITY

- Policies and programmes to halt and reverse land degradation have long suffered from the absence of a clear goal and quantitative, time-bound targets to guide action and make measurable progress.
- In October 2015, UNCCD country Parties reached a breakthrough agreement on the Land Degradation Neutrality (LDN) concept.
- Land Degradation Neutrality (LDN) has been defined by the Parties to the Convention as -
 - ✓ A state whereby the amount and quality of land resources, necessary to support ecosystem functions and services and enhance food security, remains stable or increases within specified temporal and spatial scales and ecosystems.
 - ✓ LDN is a simple idea and a powerful tool. It means securing enough healthy and productive natural resources by avoiding degradation whenever possible and restoring land that has already been degraded.
 - ✓ To date, 123 countries have engaged with the LDN Target Setting Programme and considerable progress has been made since the 2030 Agenda was adopted in 2015.

THE UNCCD 2018–2030 STRATEGIC FRAMEWORK

The strategy will contribute to achieving the objectives of the Convention and SDG 15.3.

- Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 15, target 3 (SDG 15.3) states - “By 2030, combat desertification, restore degraded land and soil, including land affected by desertification, drought and floods, and strive to achieve a land degradation-neutral world.”
- SDG 15.3 has become a strong vehicle for driving UNCCD implementation.

15 LIFE
ON LAND

SDG Target 15.3



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THE UNCCD 2018–2030 STRATEGIC FRAMEWORK

▪ Strategic objective 1

- ✓ To improve the condition of affected ecosystems, combat desertification/land degradation, promote sustainable land management and contribute to land degradation neutrality.

▪ Strategic objective 2

- ✓ To improve the living conditions of affected populations.

▪ Strategic objective 3

- ✓ To mitigate, adapt to, and manage the effects of drought in order to enhance resilience of vulnerable populations and ecosystems.

▪ Strategic objective 4

- ✓ To generate global environmental benefits through effective implementation of the UNCCD.

▪ Strategic objective 5

- ✓ To mobilize substantial and additional financial and non-financial resources to support the implementation of the Convention by building effective partnerships at global and national level.



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